

NOW, PLUG AND RIDE

COMPANY YoBykes | **WHAT THEY DO Produce Battery-driven Scooters** | **TURNOVER Rs 50 crore**

SHAILESH RAVAL / www.indiatodayimages.com

A plug point is all you need to travel from one place to the next. No, you needn't wait for 2050; it's here and now. YoByke, a battery-operated, gearless, zero-emission scooter is making your commute both cheap and green. "It is environment-friendly and the best alternative available for mobility without pollution," says Shailesh Bhandari, managing director, Electrotherm India, manufacturer of YoBykes. Set up in 2006 as a brainchild of company Chairman Mukesh Bhandari, the response in the very first year was promising with 30,000 bikes sold through its 300 dealers and showrooms. Today, the factory in Kutch churns out 50,000 units every year. Priced between Rs 25,000 and Rs 40,000, the bike matches most conventional two-wheelers in the market and can run 75 km on a full charge. Over the last three years, the research department has developed four models of varying capacity—Smart, Speed, Election and Explore—with a high-powered 100 cc scooter ready for a June launch. Says Shailesh: "In an age when it is imperative to reduce greenhouse gases, the authorities should take measures to encourage such products."

SHAILESH BHANDARI (LEFT) AND MAHESH BHANDARI

MONEY FROM NOTHING

COMPANY Ramky Enviro Engineers Limited | **WHAT THEY DO Waste Management** | **TURNOVER Rs 353 crore**

Turning waste to wealth is brisk business. That is what an environmental engineer Alla Ayodhya Rami Reddy has discovered in promoting Ramky Enviro Engineers Limited that has emerged as one of India's leading integrated environmental and waste management infrastructure provider. "For us, it is both a business opportunity and a social responsibility to protect the environment while making profits," says the group's CEO Dinesh K. Khare. With these watchwords, Ramky is operating 11 hazardous waste management facilities, 14 hospital waste management facilities and 10 municipal solid waste management facilities across India. The company has also signed MoUs with state governments to set up 19 municipal integrated recycling facilities. Moreover, Ramky has joined hands with ITC in its initiative to recycle solid waste by providing households in Andhra Pradesh with bags to collect recyclable waste and then send it for reprocessing. The collection teams pay households Rs 4 per kg for paper and Rs 2 per kg for plastics and metals and employ 50 persons, usually ragpickers, for every 50,000 households. Now, the group is examining the prospects of converting urban waste into power, though at Rs 12 crore a MW, almost three times the cost of energy generated from conventional sources, it seems to be an expensive project. The company is also exploring the potential of waste management in Saudi Arabia and Oman.

ALLA AYODHYA
RAMI REDDY



PER CENT OF A HOUSEHOLD ELECTRICITY BILL.